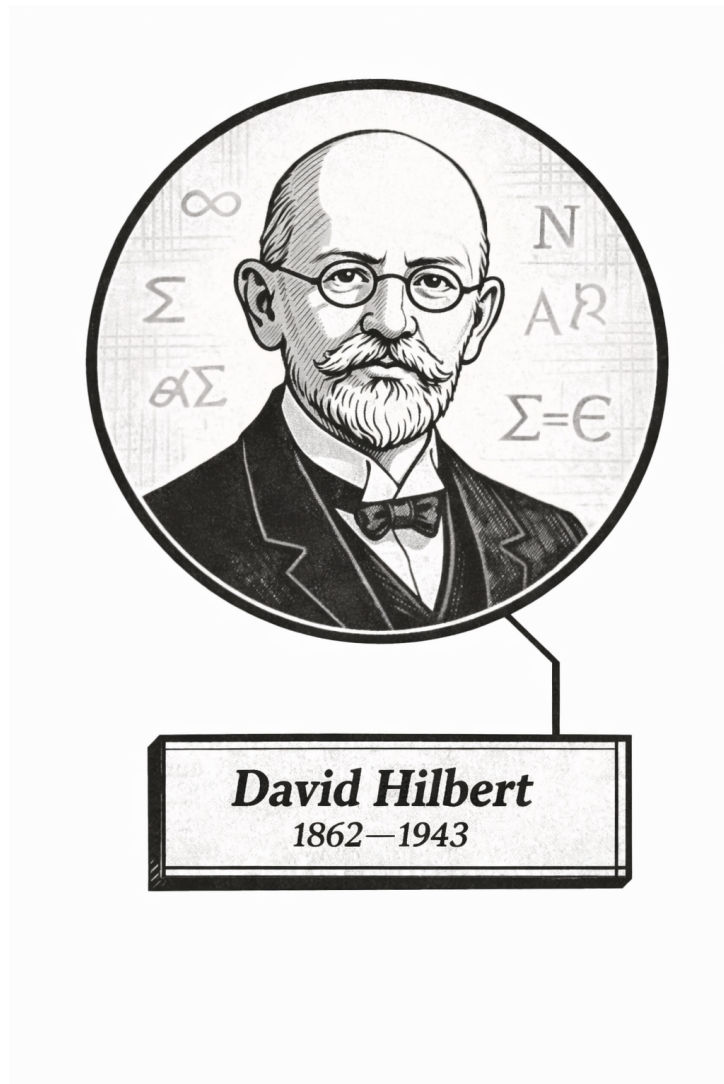


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Volume VIII

Mathematical Logic and Foundations



Frontispiece placeholder.

David Hilbert, 1862–1943

Volume VIII

Mathematical Logic and Foundations

Self-Study Notes

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June 23, 2026

Part I

Mathematical Logic and Foundations

Chapter 1

Category Theory

category-theory

Numerical PDE $\rightarrow$ **Category Theory** $\rightarrow$ Model Theory

1.1 Category Theory

Remark (Planned content). Active mathematical content has not yet been added.

Chapter 2

Model Theory

model-theory

Category Theory $\rightarrow$ Model Theory $\rightarrow$ Proof Theory

2.1 Languages and Structures

L-Structures Toolkit — Quick Reference

Concept	Symbol / Notation	Detail
First-order language	$\mathcal{L}$	$\downarrow$
L-structure	$\mathcal{M} = (M, \mathcal{L}^{\mathcal{M}})$	$\downarrow$
Domain / universe	$ \mathcal{M} $ or M	$\downarrow$
Interpretation of f	$f^{\mathcal{M}} : M^n \rightarrow M$	$\downarrow$
Interpretation of R	$R^{\mathcal{M}} \subseteq M^n$	$\downarrow$
Interpretation of c	$c^{\mathcal{M}} \in M$	$\downarrow$
Variable assignment	$s : \text{Var} \rightarrow M$	$\downarrow$
Term evaluation	$s(t) \in M$	$\downarrow$
Satisfaction	$\mathcal{M} \models \varphi[s]$	$\downarrow$

First-Order Languages

Definition (First-Order Language $\mathcal{L}$)

Definition 2.1.1 (First-Order Language $\mathcal{L}$). A **first-order language** $\mathcal{L}$ consists of three (possibly empty) sets of non-logical symbols:

- a set $\mathcal{R}$ of **relation symbols** (also called *predicate symbols*), each assigned a fixed arity $n \geq 1$;
- a set $\mathcal{F}$ of **function symbols**, each assigned a fixed **arity** $n \geq 0$ (0-ary function symbols are *constant symbols*);
- a set $\mathcal{C}$ of **constant symbols** (equivalently, 0-ary function symbols — listed separately for emphasis).

Together with the logical symbols common to all first-order languages (variables, connectives $\neg, \wedge, \vee, \rightarrow, \leftrightarrow$, quantifiers $\forall, \exists$, equality $=$, parentheses), the triple $(\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{R}, \mathcal{C})$ determines $\mathcal{L}$.

Remark (Dependencies).

- Arity
- Relation Symbol
- Function Symbol
- Constant Symbol
- Variable
- Logical Connective

Remark (Fully quantified form). $\mathcal{L} = (\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{R}, \mathcal{C})$ where $\text{ar}(f) \in \mathbb{N}$ for each $f \in \mathcal{F}$ and $\text{ar}(R) \in \mathbb{N}_{\geq 1}$ for each $R \in \mathcal{R}$.

Remark (Intuition). A language is a *vocabulary*: it names the operations, relations, and distinguished elements that can appear in sentences, without yet saying what those names mean. The meaning is supplied by a structure.

Remark (Source note). Some sources (e.g. Marker §1.1, Hodges) absorb constant symbols into 0-ary function symbols. Others (e.g. Chang–Keisler) list them separately. The content is equivalent; only the bookkeeping differs.

Remark (Consequence). The set of $\mathcal{L}$ -terms and the set of $\mathcal{L}$ -formulas are both defined inductively from $\mathcal{L}$; see [term evaluation](#) below.

Example (Standard examples of first-order languages). 1. **Language of ordered fields**

$\mathcal{L}_{\text{of}}$: function symbols $\{+, \cdot, -\}$ of arities 2, 2, 1; relation symbol $\{<\}$ of arity 2; constant symbols $\{0, 1\}$. The real field $(\mathbb{R}, +, \cdot, -, <, 0, 1)$ is an $\mathcal{L}_{\text{of}}$ -structure.

2. **Language of graphs** $\mathcal{L}_{\text{gr}}$: no function symbols, no constants; one binary relation symbol $\{E\}$ (for “edge”).

3. **Language of groups** $\mathcal{L}_{\text{gp}}$: function symbols $\{\cdot, ^{-1}\}$ of arities 2, 1; constant symbol $\{e\}$.
4. **Pure equality language** $\mathcal{L}_=$: no non-logical symbols at all. Structures are arbitrary non-empty sets.

L-Structures

Definition ($\mathcal{L}$ -Structure)

Definition 2.1.2 ($\mathcal{L}$ -Structure). Let $\mathcal{L} = (\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{R}, \mathcal{C})$ be a first-order language. An **$\mathcal{L}$ -structure** $\mathcal{M}$ consists of:

1. a non-empty set M called the **domain** (or **universe**) of $\mathcal{M}$, written $|\mathcal{M}|$;
2. for each n -ary relation symbol $R \in \mathcal{R}$, a relation $R^{\mathcal{M}} \subseteq M^n$;
3. for each n -ary function symbol $f \in \mathcal{F}$, a function $f^{\mathcal{M}} : M^n \rightarrow M$;
4. for each constant symbol $c \in \mathcal{C}$, a distinguished element $c^{\mathcal{M}} \in M$.

The superscript notation $f^{\mathcal{M}}, R^{\mathcal{M}}, c^{\mathcal{M}}$ denotes the **interpretation** of each symbol in $\mathcal{M}$.

Remark (Dependencies).

- [First-Order Language](#)
- Arity
- Relation Symbol
- Function Symbol
- Constant Symbol
- Relation
- Function
- Cartesian Product
- Subset

Remark (Fully quantified form). $\mathcal{M}$ is an $\mathcal{L}$ -structure iff $M \neq \emptyset$, and $\forall f \in \mathcal{F}_{(n)}, f^{\mathcal{M}} : M^n \rightarrow M$, and $\forall R \in \mathcal{R}_{(n)}, R^{\mathcal{M}} \subseteq M^n$, and $\forall c \in \mathcal{C}, c^{\mathcal{M}} \in M$.

Remark (Intuition). A structure is an $\mathcal{L}$ -vocabulary *made concrete*: each symbol is assigned an actual mathematical object of the correct type. The domain provides the raw material; the interpretations give the symbols their meaning inside that domain.

Remark (Common error). The domain M must be *non-empty*. First-order logic with an empty domain is pathological: $\forall x \varphi$ would be vacuously true and $\exists x \varphi$ vacuously false for every φ , breaking the duality of the quantifiers.

Remark (Source note). Some sources write $\mathfrak{M}$ (Fraktur) for structures and reserve M for the domain; others use $\mathcal{M}$ throughout and write $|\mathcal{M}|$ for the domain. The latter convention is used here. Marker uses $\mathcal{M}$; Enderton uses $\mathfrak{A}$.

Example (L-structures for familiar mathematical objects). 1. $(\mathbb{R}, +^{\mathbb{R}}, \cdot^{\mathbb{R}}, -^{\mathbb{R}}, <^{\mathbb{R}}, 0^{\mathbb{R}}, 1^{\mathbb{R}})$ is an $\mathcal{L}_{\text{of}}$ -structure with domain $M = \mathbb{R}$.

2. $(\mathbb{Q}, +^{\mathbb{Q}}, \cdot^{\mathbb{Q}}, -^{\mathbb{Q}}, <^{\mathbb{Q}}, 0^{\mathbb{Q}}, 1^{\mathbb{Q}})$ is another $\mathcal{L}_{\text{of}}$ -structure with domain $M = \mathbb{Q}$.

3. The complete graph K_3 on $\{1, 2, 3\}$ is an $\mathcal{L}_{\text{gr}}$ -structure with $E^{K_3} = \{(1, 2), (2, 1), (1, 3), (3, 1), (2, 3), (3, 2)\}$.

Two different structures can share the same language — the language only fixes the *type* of the interpretations, not their specific content.

Variable Assignments

Definition (Variable Assignment)

Definition 2.1.3 (Variable Assignment). Let $\mathcal{M}$ be an $\mathcal{L}$ -structure with domain M , and let $\text{Var} = \{v_1, v_2, v_3, \dots\}$ be a fixed countable set of first-order variables. A **variable assignment** (or **environment**) for $\mathcal{M}$ is a function $s : \text{Var} \rightarrow M$. For a variable assignment s , a variable v_i , and an element $a \in M$, write $s[v_i \mapsto a]$ for the assignment that agrees with s on all variables except v_i , where it returns a :

$$s[v_i \mapsto a](v_j) = \begin{cases} a & \text{if } j = i, \\ s(v_j) & \text{if } j \neq i. \end{cases}$$

Remark (Dependencies).

- $\mathcal{L}$ -Structure
- Variable
- Function
- Countable

Remark (Fully quantified form). $s : \text{Var} \rightarrow M$, and $s[v_i \mapsto a](v_j) = a$ if $j = i$, else $s(v_j)$.

Remark (Intuition). A variable assignment gives temporary values to free variables before evaluating a formula. The $s[v_i \mapsto a]$ notation is the standard tool for handling quantifier rules: to check $\exists v_i \varphi$, test whether $\mathcal{M} \models \varphi[s[v_i \mapsto a]]$ for some $a \in M$.

Term Evaluation

Definition (Term Evaluation)

Definition 2.1.4 (Term Evaluation). Let $\mathcal{M}$ be an $\mathcal{L}$ -structure and $s : \text{Var} \rightarrow M$ a variable assignment. The **evaluation** $s(t) \in M$ of an $\mathcal{L}$ -term t under s is defined inductively:

1. If $t = v_i$ is a variable, then $s(t) = s(v_i)$.
2. If $t = c$ is a constant symbol, then $s(t) = c^{\mathcal{M}}$.
3. If $t = f(t_1, \dots, t_n)$ for an n -ary function symbol f , then $s(t) = f^{\mathcal{M}}(s(t_1), \dots, s(t_n))$.

Remark (Dependencies).

- $\mathcal{L}$ -Structure
- Variable Assignment
- Term
- Variable
- Arity
- Function Symbol
- Constant Symbol

Remark (Fully quantified form). $s : \text{Var} \rightarrow M$, and $s(t) \in M$ for every $\mathcal{L}$ -term t . Formally: $s(\cdot)$ is the unique function on terms satisfying clauses (1)–(3).

Remark (Intuition). Term evaluation is the “computation” step: given concrete values for all variables, every term reduces to an element of M . The inductive definition mirrors the inductive definition of terms themselves.

Satisfaction [Stub]

Definition (Satisfaction, $\mathcal{M} \models \varphi[s]$) — Stub

Let $\mathcal{M}$ be an $\mathcal{L}$ -structure, s a variable assignment, and φ an $\mathcal{L}$ -formula. The **satisfaction relation** $\mathcal{M} \models \varphi[s]$ (read: “ $\mathcal{M}$ satisfies φ under s ”) is defined inductively on the structure of φ :

[To be filled in — clauses for atomic formulas, negation, conjunction, disjunction, implication, existential quantifier, universal quantifier.]

Remark (Fully quantified form). *[Stub — to be completed.]*

Remark (Intuition). Satisfaction is the semantic notion of truth: $\mathcal{M} \models \varphi[s]$ means φ is true in $\mathcal{M}$ when each free variable v_i takes the value $s(v_i)$. The definition proceeds by induction on formula complexity, grounding out on atomic formulas evaluated via term evaluation.

Elementary Equivalence and Substructures [Stub]

Chapter 3

Proof Theory

proof-theory

Model Theory $\rightarrow$ **Proof Theory** $\rightarrow$ Type Theory

3.1 Proof Theory

Remark (Planned content). Active mathematical content has not yet been added.

Chapter 4

Type Theory

type-theory

Proof Theory $\rightarrow$ **Type Theory** $\rightarrow$ Lambda Calculus

4.1 Type Theory

Remark (Planned content). Active mathematical content has not yet been added.

Chapter 5

Lambda Calculus

lambda-calculus

Type Theory $\rightarrow$ **Lambda Calculus** $\rightarrow$ Algebras of Sets

5.1 Lambda Terms

Section Toolkit — Quick Reference

Concept	One-line summary
λ -term	Variable x , abstraction $\lambda x.M$, application MN
α -equivalence	$\lambda x.M =_{\alpha} \lambda y.M[y/x]$ when y fresh
β -reduction	$(\lambda x.M)N \rightarrow_{\beta} M[N/x]$
Normal form	Term with no β -redex; may not exist (non-termination)
Church boolean T	$\lambda x.\lambda y.x$
Church boolean F	$\lambda x.\lambda y.y$
Church numeral $\bar{n}$	$\lambda f.\lambda x.f^n(x)$ (f applied n times to x)
Type $\tau \rightarrow \sigma$	Function type: input of type τ , output of type σ
Typing judgment	$\Gamma \vdash M : \tau$ reads “ M has type τ in context Γ ”
Curry–Howard	Propositions are types; proofs are terms; $A \rightarrow B$ is implication

Untyped Lambda Calculus

Background References

- **First-order logic:** Enderton [1972], Barwise [1977a].
- **General topology:** Kelly [1955].
- **Set theory:** Halmos [1960], van Dalen et al. [1978].
- **Recursion theory:** Rogers [1967].
- **Category theory:** Arbib and Manes [1975], MacLane [1972].

Definition — Lambda Terms

Definition 5.1.1 (Lambda Terms). The set Λ of λ -terms is defined inductively as follows:

1. Every variable x is a λ -term.
2. If M is a λ -term and x is a variable, then

$$\lambda x. M$$

is a λ -term.

3. If M and N are λ -terms, then

$$MN$$

is a λ -term.

Remark (Standard quantified statement).

$M \in \Lambda \iff M$ is generated from variables by finitely many applications of $\lambda x.(\cdot)$ and $(\cdot)(\cdot)$. ■

Remark (Interpretation). The λ -terms are the smallest set closed under three constructions: variables, abstraction (function formation), and application (function evaluation). This inductive definition plays the same role as recursive definitions in analysis or algebra: every λ -term is built from variables by finitely many applications of abstraction and application.

Remark (Structural View). Every λ -term has a tree structure:

- variables are leaves,
- abstractions $\lambda x. M$ are unary nodes,
- applications MN are binary nodes.

Thus Λ is a freely generated syntactic algebra.

Chapter 6

Algebras of Sets

algebras-of-sets

Lambda Calculus $\rightarrow$ **Algebras of Sets** $\rightarrow$ Torus Renders

6.1 Rings of Sets

Toolkit — Boolean Ring Examples

Concept family: Concrete Boolean ring examples and structural constraints.

Atomic items in this section:

- Remark: No Boolean ring of order 3 exists
- Example: The four-element Boolean ring $\mathbf{2}^2$
- Remark: Boolean rings have order 2^n

Key constraint: $(R, +)$ in any Boolean ring is an elementary abelian 2-group, so $|R| = 2^n$ for some $n \geq 0$.

Toolkit — Boolean Rings

Concept family: Boolean rings (Halmos–Givant §1) and their immediate consequences from the single idempotence axiom.

Atomic items in this section:

- Definition: Boolean Ring
- Definition: Idempotent Element
- Definition: Characteristic 2
- Lemma: Self Additive Inverse ($p + p = 0$)
- Lemma: Self Negation ($-p = p$)

Key predicate:

$$\text{BooleanRing}(R, +, \cdot, -, 0, 1) \equiv \text{Ring}(R, +, \cdot, -, 0, 1) \wedge \text{IdempotentRing}(R, \cdot).$$

Central theorem chain: Idempotence $\Rightarrow$ Characteristic 2 $\Rightarrow$ Self Negation ($-p = p$) $\Rightarrow$ Commutativity of $\cdot$.

Toolkit — Rings of Sets

Concept family: The ring axioms (Halmos–Givant §1) as the algebraic foundation for Boolean algebras of sets.

Atomic items in this section:

- Definition: Ring

Key predicate:

$$\text{Ring}(R, +, \cdot, -, 0, 1) \equiv \text{AbelianGroup}(R, +, -, 0) \wedge \text{Monoid}(R, \cdot, 1) \wedge \text{Distributes}(\cdot, +, R). \blacksquare$$

Axiom numbering follows Halmos–Givant; axiom (4) (commutativity of multiplication) is not a ring axiom but a theorem in the Boolean setting.

Definition — Ring

Definition 6.1.1 (Ring). A **ring** is a non-empty set R together with two binary operations $+$ and $\cdot$ on R , a unary operation $-$ on R , and two distinguished elements $0, 1 \in R$, satisfying the following axioms for all $p, q, r \in R$:

- (1) $p + (q + r) = (p + q) + r$ *(additive associativity)*
- (2) $p \cdot (q \cdot r) = (p \cdot q) \cdot r$ *(multiplicative associativity)*
- (3) $p + q = q + p$ *(additive commutativity)*
- (5) $p + 0 = p$ *(additive identity)*
- (6) $p \cdot 1 = p$ *(multiplicative identity)*
- (7) $p + (-p) = 0$ *(additive inverse)*
- (8) $p \cdot (q + r) = p \cdot q + p \cdot r$ *(left distributivity)*
- (9) $(q + r) \cdot p = q \cdot p + r \cdot p$ *(right distributivity)*

Axiom numbering follows Halmos–Givant [Halmos and Givant \[2009\]](#); axiom (4) is commutativity of multiplication, which is not a ring axiom but a theorem in the Boolean setting. A ring possessing a distinguished element 1 satisfying axiom (6) is called a **ring with unit**. A ring satisfying $p \cdot q = q \cdot p$ for all $p, q \in R$ is called a **commutative ring**.

Remark (Standard quantified statement).

$$\begin{aligned}
 (R, +, \cdot, -, 0, 1) \text{ is a ring} &\iff \forall p, q, r \in R: \\
 &\quad p + (q + r) = (p + q) + r \\
 &\quad \wedge \quad p \cdot (q \cdot r) = (p \cdot q) \cdot r \\
 &\quad \wedge \quad p + q = q + p \\
 &\quad \wedge \quad p + 0 = p \\
 &\quad \wedge \quad p \cdot 1 = p \\
 &\quad \wedge \quad p + (-p) = 0 \\
 &\quad \wedge \quad p \cdot (q + r) = p \cdot q + p \cdot r \\
 &\quad \wedge \quad (q + r) \cdot p = q \cdot p + r \cdot p.
 \end{aligned}$$

Remark (Definition predicate reading).

$$\text{Ring}(R, +, \cdot, -, 0, 1) \iff \text{AbelianGroup}(R, +, -, 0) \wedge \text{Monoid}(R, \cdot, 1) \wedge \text{Distributes}(\cdot, +, R) \blacksquare$$

Remark (Negated quantified statement).

$$\begin{aligned}
(R, +, \cdot, -, 0, 1) \text{ is \textbf{not} a ring} &\iff \exists p, q, r \in R: \\
& p + (q + r) \neq (p + q) + r \\
\vee \quad & p \cdot (q \cdot r) \neq (p \cdot q) \cdot r \\
\vee \quad & p + q \neq q + p \\
\vee \quad & p + 0 \neq p \\
\vee \quad & p \cdot 1 \neq p \\
\vee \quad & p + (-p) \neq 0 \\
\vee \quad & p \cdot (q + r) \neq p \cdot q + p \cdot r \\
\vee \quad & (q + r) \cdot p \neq q \cdot p + r \cdot p.
\end{aligned}$$

Remark (Failure modes). The failure modes are exactly the ways that one of the defining structural conditions can fail.

Remark (Failure mode decomposition). The eight axioms partition into three structural groups:

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
\underbrace{(1), (3), (5), (7)} & \underbrace{(2), (6)} & \underbrace{(8), (9)} \\
\text{AbelianGroup}(R, +, -, 0) & \text{Monoid}(R, \cdot, 1) & \text{Distributes}(\cdot, +, R)
\end{array}$$

A structure violating any axiom in the first group lacks a coherent additive group. A structure violating any axiom in the second group lacks a multiplicative identity or associativity. A structure violating the third group possesses two individually well-behaved operations that do not interact coherently; distributivity is the sole structural bridge between $+$ and $\cdot$, and its failure is sufficient to destroy the ring property.

Remark (Interpretation). A ring abstracts the arithmetic of the integers. The additive structure is always a commutative group. The multiplicative structure is a monoid — associative with unit — but need not be commutative; axiom (4) of Halmos–Givant, commutativity of multiplication, is absent from the ring axioms. In the Boolean setting, multiplicative commutativity is not assumed but derived as a theorem from idempotence alone. Distributivity encodes the coherent interaction between the two operations: it is the axiom that makes $\cdot$ and $+$ form a single algebraic system rather than two independent ones.

Definition — Boolean Ring

Definition 6.1.2 (Boolean Ring). A **Boolean ring** is an idempotent ring with unit. That is, a Boolean ring is a ring $(R, +, \cdot, -, 0, 1)$ satisfying the additional axiom:

$$p \cdot p = p \quad \text{for all } p \in R. \quad (11)$$

An element p satisfying $p \cdot p = p$ is called **idempotent**. A ring in which every element is idempotent is called an **idempotent ring**.

The official axiom set for a Boolean ring consists of axioms (1)–(3), (5), (6), (8)–(11), where axiom (7) (the additive inverse law) is replaced by axiom (10) (characteristic 2), which is derived as a theorem. Axiom numbering follows Halmos–Givant [Halmos and Givant \[2009\]](#).

Remark (Standard quantified statement).

$$\text{BooleanRing}(R, +, \cdot, -, 0, 1) \iff \text{Ring}(R, +, \cdot, -, 0, 1) \wedge \forall p \in R: p \cdot p = p.$$

Remark (Definition predicate reading).

$$\text{BooleanRing}(R, +, \cdot, -, 0, 1) \iff \text{Ring}(R, +, \cdot, -, 0, 1) \wedge \text{IdempotentRing}(R, \cdot)$$

Remark (Negated quantified statement).

$$\neg \text{BooleanRing}(R, +, \cdot, -, 0, 1) \iff \neg \text{Ring}(R, +, \cdot, -, 0, 1) \vee \exists p \in R: p \cdot p \neq p.$$

Remark (Failure modes). The failure modes are exactly the ways that one of the defining structural conditions can fail.

Remark (Failure mode decomposition). A structure fails to be a Boolean ring in exactly one of two ways:

$$\underbrace{\neg \text{Ring}(R, +, \cdot, -, 0, 1)}_{\text{fails a ring axiom}} \quad \vee \quad \underbrace{\exists p \in R: p \cdot p \neq p}_{\text{some element is not idempotent}}$$

The second failure mode is the structurally interesting one. A ring in which even one element fails $p \cdot p = p$ is not Boolean. The simplest example: the ring $\mathbb{Z}$ of integers fails idempotence at every element except 0 and 1.

Remark (Canonical examples).

- $\mathbf{2} = \{0, 1\}$ with addition mod 2 and ordinary multiplication is the simplest non-degenerate Boolean ring.
- $\mathbf{2}^n$, the set of all n -tuples of elements of $\mathbf{2}$, with coordinatewise addition and multiplication, is a Boolean ring with 2^n elements. The zero is $(0, \dots, 0)$ and the unit is $(1, \dots, 1)$.
- $(\mathcal{P}(X), \Delta, \cap)$, the power set of any set X with symmetric difference as addition and intersection as multiplication, is a Boolean ring. Under the correspondence $A \leftrightarrow \mathbf{1}_A$ (the characteristic function of A), this ring is isomorphic to $\mathbf{2}^X$.

Remark (Interpretation). A Boolean ring is the minimal algebraic structure that forces the full Boolean calculus to emerge from a single additional axiom — idempotence of multiplication. The ring axioms supply the additive abelian group and the multiplicative monoid with distributivity. Idempotence then forces characteristic 2 (every element equals its own additive inverse), forces commutativity of multiplication, and identifies the ring with a field of sets via the representation theorem (Halmos–Givant, Chapter 22). The abstract definition thus captures exactly the algebra of set-theoretic operations: symmetric difference plays the role of addition and intersection plays the role of multiplication.

Remark (Dependencies).

- Definition: Ring

Example (The two-element Boolean ring). The simplest non-degenerate Boolean ring is the two-element ring $\mathbf{2} = \{0, 1\}$. Its addition and multiplication are given by the following tables.

$+$	0	1
0	0	1
1	1	0

$\cdot$	0	1
0	0	0
1	0	1

Addition in $\mathbf{2}$ is addition modulo 2: $1 + 1 = 0$. Multiplication in $\mathbf{2}$ is ordinary multiplication of integers restricted to $\{0, 1\}$. Every element of $\mathbf{2}$ satisfies $p + p = 0$ and $p \cdot p = p$, making $\mathbf{2}$ the canonical example against which both axioms (10) and (11) are verified.

Definition — Idempotent Element

Definition 6.1.3 (Idempotent Element). An element p of a ring R is called **idempotent** if

$$p \cdot p = p.$$

A ring in which every element is idempotent is called an **idempotent ring**.

Remark (Standard quantified statement).

$$\text{IdempotentElement}(p, R, \cdot) \iff p \cdot p = p.$$

$$\text{IdempotentRing}(R, \cdot) \iff \forall p \in R: p \cdot p = p.$$

Remark (Definition predicate reading).

$$\text{IdempotentElement}(p, R, \cdot) \iff \text{IdempotentRing}(R, \cdot) \iff \forall p \in R: \text{IdempotentElement}(p, R, \cdot)$$

Remark (Negated quantified statement).

$$\neg \text{IdempotentElement}(p, R, \cdot) \iff p \cdot p \neq p.$$

Remark (Interpretation). Idempotence is the single additional axiom that forces Boolean structure. In the two-element ring $\mathbf{2}$, verification is immediate: $0 \cdot 0 = 0$ and $1 \cdot 1 = 1$. In a power set algebra $\mathcal{P}(X)$, idempotence of intersection — $A \cap A = A$ — is the set-theoretic counterpart. The force of the axiom is not in these examples but in what it implies for an arbitrary ring: characteristic 2 and commutativity of multiplication both follow from idempotence alone, as the theorems below establish.

Remark (Dependencies).

- Definition: Ring

Definition — Characteristic 2

Definition 6.1.4 (Characteristic 2). A ring R is said to have **characteristic 2** if

$$p + p = 0 \quad \text{for all } p \in R. \tag{10}$$

Remark (Standard quantified statement).

$$\text{Characteristic2}(R, +, 0) \iff \forall p \in R: p + p = 0.$$

Remark (Definition predicate reading).

$$\text{Characteristic2}(R, +, 0) \iff \forall p \in R: \text{IdempotentElement}(p, R, +)$$

Remark (Negated quantified statement).

$$\neg \text{Characteristic2}(R, +, 0) \iff \exists p \in R: p + p \neq 0.$$

Remark (Interpretation). Characteristic 2 means that every element is its own additive inverse: $p + p = 0$ says precisely $p = -p$. The operation of negation therefore becomes the identity map — applying $-$ to any element returns that element unchanged. Halmos observes that in a ring of characteristic 2, the minus sign for additive inverses is never needed and is henceforth dropped. Axiom (7), $p + (-p) = 0$, is replaced in the official Boolean ring axiom set by the stronger equation (10), $p + p = 0$, which is a theorem derived from idempotence.

Remark (Dependencies).

- [Definition: Boolean Ring](#)
- [Definition: Idempotent Element](#)

Lemma

Lemma 6.1.5 (Self Additive Inverse). *In any Boolean ring R ,*

$$p + p = 0 \quad \text{for all } p \in R.$$

Go to proof.

Remark (Standard quantified statement).

$$\forall p \in R: p + p = 0.$$

Remark (Definition predicate reading).

$$\text{BooleanRing}(R, +, \cdot, -, 0, 1) \implies \text{Characteristic2}(R, +, 0).$$

Remark (Interpretation). This is Halmos consequence (a): idempotence of multiplication forces the additive structure to have characteristic 2. The proof expands $(p + q)^2$ by distributivity and idempotence, cancels p and q , then sets $p = q$ to obtain $p + p = 0$. The Lean 4 formalisation is `AdditiveIdempotence` in `BooleanAlgebraDefinitions.lean`.

Remark (Dependencies).

- [Definition: Boolean Ring](#)
- [Definition: Characteristic 2](#)

Lemma

Lemma 6.1.6 (Self Negation). *In any Boolean ring R ,*

$$-p = p \quad \text{for all } p \in R.$$

Go to proof.

Remark (Standard quantified statement).

$$\forall p \in R: -p = p.$$

Remark (Interpretation). This follows immediately from 6.1.5. Since $p + p = 0$ and $p + (-p) = 0$ both hold, the uniqueness of additive inverses gives $-p = p$. The negation operation is therefore the identity map on any Boolean ring. Halmos uses this to drop the minus sign entirely from his notation for the rest of the book: since $-p = p$, writing $-p$ and writing p are the same thing.

Remark (Dependencies).

- [Lemma: Self Additive Inverse](#)

Remark (No Boolean ring of order 3). A Boolean ring of order 3 does not exist. The additive group $(R, +)$ of any Boolean ring satisfies $p + p = 0$ for all p , by Lemma 6.1.5. Every element therefore has additive order dividing 2, so $(R, +)$ is an elementary abelian 2-group. Elementary abelian 2-groups have order 2^n for some $n \geq 0$. Since 3 is not a power of 2, no Boolean ring of order 3 can exist.

Example (The four-element Boolean ring $\mathbf{2}^2$). The smallest Boolean ring with more than two elements is $\mathbf{2}^2 = \{(0, 0), (0, 1), (1, 0), (1, 1)\}$, the set of ordered pairs from $\mathbf{2} = \{0, 1\}$. Addition and multiplication are defined coordinatewise:

$$(p_0, p_1) + (q_0, q_1) = (p_0 + q_0, p_1 + q_1), \quad (p_0, p_1) \cdot (q_0, q_1) = (p_0 \cdot q_0, p_1 \cdot q_1),$$

where each coordinate is computed in $\mathbf{2}$. The zero element is $(0, 0)$ and the unit is $(1, 1)$.

Addition table.

+	(0, 0)	(0, 1)	(1, 0)	(1, 1)
(0, 0)	(0, 0)	(0, 1)	(1, 0)	(1, 1)
(0, 1)	(0, 1)	(0, 0)	(1, 1)	(1, 0)
(1, 0)	(1, 0)	(1, 1)	(0, 0)	(0, 1)
(1, 1)	(1, 1)	(1, 0)	(0, 1)	(0, 0)

Multiplication table.

·	(0, 0)	(0, 1)	(1, 0)	(1, 1)
(0, 0)	(0, 0)	(0, 0)	(0, 0)	(0, 0)
(0, 1)	(0, 0)	(0, 1)	(0, 0)	(0, 1)
(1, 0)	(0, 0)	(0, 0)	(1, 0)	(1, 0)
(1, 1)	(0, 0)	(0, 1)	(1, 0)	(1, 1)

Verification of idempotence. Every element squares to itself:

p	$p \cdot p$
(0, 0)	(0, 0)
(0, 1)	(0, 1)
(1, 0)	(1, 0)
(1, 1)	(1, 1)

Verification of characteristic 2. Every element is its own additive inverse:

p	$p + p$
$(0, 0)$	$(0, 0)$
$(0, 1)$	$(0, 0)$
$(1, 0)$	$(0, 0)$
$(1, 1)$	$(0, 0)$

Remark (Boolean rings have order 2^n). Every finite Boolean ring is isomorphic to $\mathbf{2}^n$ for some $n \geq 0$, and therefore has exactly 2^n elements. This follows from the representation theorem (Halmos–Givant, Chapter 22): every Boolean algebra is isomorphic to a field of sets, and every finite field of sets is isomorphic to $\mathcal{P}(X)$ for some finite set X with $|X| = n$, giving $|\mathcal{P}(X)| = 2^n$. The permissible finite sizes are $1, 2, 4, 8, 16, \dots$ and no other cardinality is achievable.

Bibliography

Paul R. Halmos and Steven Givant. *Introduction to Boolean Algebras*. Springer, 2009.